NOT MEASUREMENT SENSITIVE

MIL-DTL-3943/20G
2 July 2021
SUPERSEDING
MIL-DTL-3943/20F
29 August 2016

DETAIL SPECIFICATION SHEET

DECORATION, GOLD LIFE-SAVING MEDAL AND BAR, U. S. COAST GUARD

This specification is approved for use by all
Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense

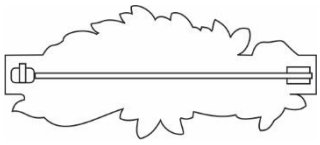
The requirements for acquiring the product described herein shall consist of this specification sheet and the latest issue of MIL-DTL-3943.



OBVERSE -1, -3



OBVERSE -2, -4



REVERSE



REVERSE

DASH NO.
-1: Gold Life-Saving Medal, Regular Size
-2: Gold Life-Saving Bar, Regular Size
-3: Gold Life-Saving Medal, Miniature Size
-4: Gold Life-Saving Bar, Miniature Size

FINISH: Matte Finish and shall match The Institute of Heraldry (TIOH) Metal Finish Chip Number 7.

MATERIAL:
-1, -3:
PENDANT AND SUSPENSION BAR: 24 Karat Gold
PENDANT RIBBON ATTACHMENT BAR: 21 Karat Gold
PIN, HINGE AND CATCH (ON ATTACHMENT BAR), PENDANT SWIVEL, SWIVEL EYE, ATTACHMENT RING: 14 Karat Gold

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:50Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

-2, -4:
PENDANT AND SUSPENSION BAR: 24 Karat Gold
PIN, HINGE AND CATCH (ON ATTACHMENT BAR): 14 Karat Gold

DIMENSIONS:
-1, -3:
PENDANT:
DIAMETER:
-1: 1-15/32 inches (REF)
-3: 3/4 inch (REF)
THICKNESS (At rim):
-1: 0.120 inch ± 0.010 inch
-3: 0.100 inch ± 0.010 inch
SUSPENSION BAR:
HEIGHT (Overall):
-1: 15/16 inch (REF)
-3: 25/32 inch (REF)
WIDTH (Overall):
-1: 1-9/16 inches (REF)
-3: 25/32 inch (REF)
THICKNESS (At thickest point):
-1, -3: 0.095 inch ± 0.010 inch
-2, -4:
HEIGHT (Overall):
-2: 9/16 inch (REF)
-4: 9/32 inch (REF)
WIDTH (Overall):
-2: 1-21/32 inches (REF)
-4: 53/64 inch (REF)
THICKNESS (At thickest point):
-2, -4: 0.095 inch ± 0.010 inch

WEIGHT (Minimum):

-1 (PENDANT AND SUSPENSION BAR ONLY, ASSEMBLED):	950 Grains
-2 (INCLUDING ATTACHING DEVICE):	253 Grains
-3 (PENDANT AND SUSPENSION BAR ONLY, ASSEMBLED):	460 Grains
-4 (INCLUDING ATTACHING DEVICE):	130 Grains

DECORATION SET: Decoration set shall consist of a regular size medal and bar, a service ribbon and a lapel button all packaged in a presentation case conforming to MIL-DTL-14633, Type VIII, Style 6 with a Class 1, 1A or 3 pad.

NOTES:
1. The term (REF) refers to the measurements taken from the Government furnished hub or die.

2. Thickness is given for information only. Weight governs.

3. The suspension bar ring shall be fabricated from 0.050 inch ± 0.002 inch nominal diameter wire for -1 and 0.032 inch ± 0.002 inch nominal diameter wire for -3. The rings shall be gold soldered to the vertical center line of the suspension bar 5/32 inch ± 1/64 inch above the tip of the eagle's beak for -1 and 5/64 inch ± 1/64 inch for -3.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:50Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4. The swivel eye ring shall be fabricated from 0.044 inch ± 0.002 inch nominal diameter wire for -1 and 0.030 inch ± 0.002 inch nominal diameter wire for -3. The rings shall be swaged in the swivel device.

5. The swivel device shall be gold soldered to the top of the pendant.

6. The ribbon attachment bar shall conform to Type III Ribbon Bar as shown on TIOH Drawing 4-4-86.

7. The pin and catch attaching device for -2 and -4 shall be located on and soldered to the horizontal center line equidistant from each side. The attaching device shall be 1-5/8 inch ± 1/64 inch for -2 and 13/16 inch ± 1/64 inch for -4.

8. The specification slash sheet for the ribbon for the pendant drape and for the service ribbon is MIL-DTL-11589/66.

9. The specification slash sheet for the lapel button is MIL-DTL-11484/7.

CHANGES FROM PREVIOUS ISSUE: Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extent of the changes.

Custodians:
Army - IH
Navy - CG1

Preparing activity:
Army - IH

Review activity:
DLA - CT

(Project No. 8455-2021-555)

NOTE: The activities listed above were interested in this document as of the date of this document. Since organizations and responsibilities can change, you should verify the currency of the information above using the ASSIST Online database at https://assist.dla.mil.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:50Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.